Xero → Practical Stock Planner: File 1 – SKU Details (your product list)

Practical Stock Planner – Time-phased inventory planning. One short guide for one file. No IT skills needed – just a Xero login and Excel.

Checked: against Xero Central help pages (central.xero.com, Australian versions, read 2 Oct 2026) and in a live test in Xero's Demo Company (AU) (3 Oct 2026). **Tags: [T]** = tested on screen or in the exported file. **[V]** = checked against Xero Central (link given), not separately tested. **[U]** = unverified – check on screen. **Not yet checked** = couldn't be tested in the demo company. Excel tips are general Excel and are not tagged. If a Xero label differs slightly, pick the closest match.

What this file is: the product master. One row per SKU. Every other file links to it by SKU. Use this guide if you track your stock in Xero's **Products and services**. If your products live in an add-on such as Cin7 or Unleashed, export from the add-on instead.

Before you start

1. **Download the SKU_Details template** from the Practical Stock Planner sidebar (📥 *Templates*) – this is in Practical Stock Planner, not in Xero [T]. Practical Stock Planner accepts **CSV files only** – one CSV file per input file; this one starts from `template_SKU_Details.csv`. **Keep the template's header row exactly as it is.** After filling it in Excel, save it with **File › Save As › CSV UTF-8 (Comma delimited)**.
2. **Every item you plan needs a unique item Code.** The Xero item **Code** is your SKU. Xero suggests using "SKU, ASIN, ISBN, MPN, UPC, EAN, GTIN or another standard reference code" as the item code; codes can be up to 30 characters and names up to 50 characters [V] (Add an inventory item, Import inventory items). Codes can contain spaces and hyphens (e.g. `TSS - Black` in the demo [T]) – copy them exactly.
3. **Your user role.** Exporting the item list needs the administrator or standard role (or permission to view items) [V].
4. **Units.** Xero items have no unit-of-measure field [T]. Everything is counted in single units (the unit you buy and sell the item in).

Export steps

Source: the **Products and services** CSV export. (Don't use the *Inventory Item Details* report – it has no separate Item Code column [T].)

#	Step	Status
1	In the **Sales** menu, select **Products and services**.	[T] · Export inventory items out of Xero
2	*(Optional)* The list opens with a **Status = Active** filter; use **Add filter** to change which items are shown. Keep *Active* to leave out items you no longer use.	[T] (whether the filter changes the CSV contents – not yet checked)
3	Click **Export**, then select **CSV**. The file downloads straight away (e.g. `InventoryItems-20261003.csv`).	[T]

Actual header row of the CSV [T]: `*ItemCode, ItemName, Quantity, PurchasesDescription, PurchasesUnitPrice, PurchasesAccount, PurchasesTaxRate, SalesDescription, SalesUnitPrice, SalesAccount, SalesTaxRate, InventoryAssetAccount, CostOfGoodsSoldAccount, Status, InventoryType`

Column mapping

Xero CSV column	→ Practical Stock Planner column	Notes
***ItemCode** (the header includes the asterisk)	**SKU**	Must be unique. [T]
ItemName (or **PurchasesDescription** / **SalesDescription**)	**Description**	ItemName is max 50 characters [V]. [T]
(not held)	**UoM**	Unit of measure: the unit you count and sell stock in. `EA` means "each", one single item. No unit field in Xero [T] – type `EA` (or leave blank – Practical Stock Planner fills `EA`).
(not held)	**Group**	No category field [T]. Type your own groups, or leave blank → "Group TBD".
(not held)	**Safety Stock Weeks**	Type your target in weeks (e.g. 2), or leave blank to use the default Safety Stock Weeks you set in the app.
PurchasesUnitPrice – *or better, tracked items' average cost*	**Cost Price**	PurchasesUnitPrice = "The price you pay for the item in your base currency" (tax-inclusive if you enter bills tax-inclusive) [V] – use the price excluding sales tax (e.g. GST or VAT). For tracked items, use **Total Value ÷ Quantity** from the **Inventory Item List** report (steps in the Xero SOH guide) – the average cost Xero uses for stock [V].
(your base currency)	**Cost Price Currency**	Xero item prices are in your **base currency** [V] – e.g. type `USD` on every row. Only one currency is allowed. ⚠ If blank, Practical Stock Planner assumes **USD**.
InventoryType (`Tracked` / `Untracked`)	–	Values seen in the test [T]. Handy for spotting untracked items; tracked items also have **InventoryAssetAccount** filled [T].
(your decision)	**Status** *(optional column)*	Type `Obsolete` for any product you won't buy again. Practical Stock Planner still shows its stock and demand, but creates no planned supply for it. Leave blank (or type `Active`) for everything else. (Xero's own **Status** column shows `Active` [T] – don't copy it across.)
Quantity	–	Filled for tracked items only [T]. Use the Xero SOH guide for stock on hand.

Excel clean-up

1. Delete rows for services and non-stock items you don't plan (e.g. freight, labour) – Xero keeps them in the same list (the demo file includes *Development work* and *Training* rows [T]).
2. Check for duplicate codes: *Home › Conditional Formatting › Highlight Cells Rules › Duplicate Values* on the ItemCode column.
3. Watch for codes that Excel changes – e.g. leading zeros dropped or codes turned into dates (Xero warns about this when importing too [V]). Open the CSV via *Data › From Text/CSV* and set the ItemCode column to *Text*. Long descriptions can contain line breaks [T] – *From Text/CSV* handles these correctly.
4. Copy the finished columns into the **SKU_Details** template (paste as values), with header **SKU** (not `*ItemCode`).

Keep the CSV. Its **PurchasesDescription** and **PurchasesUnitPrice** columns help with the SKU_Supplier_Details file later.

> **Keep leading zeros in SKUs.** Format the SKU column as *Text* before you type or paste SKUs, then save with *File › Save As › CSV UTF-8 (Comma delimited)*. If you open a CSV directly in Excel (e.g. by double-clicking it), Excel can strip leading zeros (`00123` becomes `123`) – import it via *Data › From Text/CSV* instead and set the SKU column to *Text*. In Google Sheets: select the SKU column and choose *Format › Number › Plain text* before you type or paste, then save with *File › Download › Comma-separated values (.csv)*.

Checklist

- [ ] Template header row unchanged, saved as a CSV file (*File › Save As › CSV UTF-8 (Comma delimited)*).
- [ ] Services and non-stock items removed.
- [ ] Every row has a SKU, no SKU appears twice, and codes are exactly as in Xero (no lost leading zeros).
- [ ] Cost Price excluding sales tax (average cost for tracked items).
- [ ] One currency in *Cost Price Currency* (your Xero base currency, e.g. `USD`).
- [ ] Products you won't buy again marked `Obsolete`.

If an upload fails: the message *"Please upload a CSV file... Save As CSV UTF-8"* means you uploaded an Excel workbook (`.xlsx`). Open it in Excel, choose *File › Save As › CSV UTF-8 (Comma delimited)*, and upload the `.csv` file instead.

Using Google Sheets instead of Excel? Save each file with *File › Download › Comma-separated values (.csv)*. To keep leading zeros, select the SKU column and choose *Format › Number › Plain text* before you type or paste SKUs.

Questions? Contact support@practicalsupplychainplanning.com.